

Queer Out Here, Still Unheard?

Media Relations Plan for Minus18



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About Minus18

A small horizontal rainbow-colored line is positioned directly beneath the "About Minus18" title.The MINUS18 logo with its tagline is enclosed within a white rectangular box with a thin, multi-colored border. The logo itself consists of the text "MINUS18" in a large, bold, black font, followed by the tagline "CHAMPIONS FOR LGBTQIA+ YOUTH" in a smaller, bold, black font. A horizontal rainbow-colored bar is placed under the "MINUS18" text.

- Australia's national LGBTQIA+ youth charity
- Delivering school inclusion programs, youth events, and digital resources
- Vision: An Australia free from discrimination

Reference: Minus18 Foundation (n.d.). About Minus18. Available at: <https://www.minus18.org.au/about>

Situation Analysis

Minus18's 2022 report revealed:

- 78% witnessed frequent verbal abuse
- 24% felt safe to come out
- 88% lacked local LGBTQIA+ support → Two years on, media coverage is still minimal.

STUDENTS AND TEACHERS WITNESSED REGULAR, NEGATIVE VERBAL AND PHYSICAL ACTIONS TOWARDS LGBTQIA+ PEOPLE AT THEIR SCHOOL.

78%

reported witnessing regular negative **comments** about LGBTQIA+ people at their school.

22%

reported witnessing regular negative **physical actions** against LGBTQIA+ people at their school.

37%

reported that they felt it would be **safe** to come out at their school.

Reference: Minus18 Foundation (2022). Queer Out Here Report: LGBTQIA+ Inclusion in Regional and Rural Schools. Minus18.

Goal Statement

To build long-term relationships with selected mainstream media outlets to raise awareness of rural LGBTQIA+ youth issues and inspire public support through media coverage.



Target Audience



Primary Audience – Media Professionals

Matthew Wade – Editor, ABC Queer

Oversees national LGBTQIA+ coverage with a focus on rural youth visibility.

David Crowe – Chief Political Correspondent, SMH / The Age

Covers policy and education reform with national influence.

Yves Rees – Freelance Writer (SBS Voices / The Guardian)

Writes on queer identity and regional marginalisation.



Secondary Audience – Influential Publics

Alex Greenwich MP – Independent NSW
lawmaker and LGBTQIA+ advocate

Minus18 Community Champions – Rural-based
teachers, nurses, and youth workers who support
program outreach

About Minus18



- National broadcaster with strong coverage of LGBTQIA+ inclusion, education, and regional issues via ABC Queer and Education sections.
- Trusted by a broad, socially aware audience.



- Strong editorial focus on social equity, youth rights, and public education.
- Its LGBTQ+ and Education sections regularly feature in-depth, solutions-oriented stories.

These outlets align with our message, target audience, and journalistic goals.

*Reference: ABC News (n.d.). LGBTQIA+ Topics. <https://www.abc.net.au/news/topic/lgbtqia>;
The Guardian Australia (n.d.). LGBTQ+ and Education. <https://www.theguardian.com/world/lgbt-rights>*



Informative Objective



To revive mainstream media focus on the challenges faced by LGBTQIA+ youth in rural and remote schools, to raise public awareness and empathy among urban Australians, by December 2025.

Primary Target Audience (Mainstream Media Professionals)



- A long-time advocate for LGBTQIA+ issues.
- Her series Innies + Outies focuses on personal stories and inclusive storytelling.
- Has previously promoted Minus18 initiatives on social media.



Mon Schafter (ABC Queer Content Lead)



Anna Wahlquist (Journalist at The Guardian Australia)

- Has covered LGBTQIA+ issues in states like Victoria and Tasmania.
- Strong track record of writing in-depth stories on regional inclusion.
- Likely to find value in the Queer Out Here project

Tailor story support to fit each journalist's strengths and boost national media reach

Tactic 1: Visual-first media kit and inclusive pitch

- A visually engaging media kit designed for digital storytelling:
- 1–2 short video clips of rural LGBTQIA+ youth (with consent)
- High-res portraits + first-person quotes
- Framing suggestions using inclusive language
- Pitch highlights relevance to Innies + Outies and ABCQueer's audience
- Sent via LinkedIn with follow-up through ABC's producer contact form



Tactic 2: Exclusive briefing and long-form story brief

- 1:1 Zoom with Minus18's rural youth coordinator and a school contact
- Detailed story brief with:
- Regional angles (e.g. Broken Hill)
- Data on rural inclusion gaps
- Youth spokesperson available for follow-up
- Emphasises fit with Guardian's social justice reporting



Secondary Target Audience (Community Leader)



Anna Brown
(CEO, Equality Australia)

➤ National Influence

Founding CEO of Equality Australia and a prominent legal advocate for LGBTQIA+ inclusion.

➤ Public Visibility

Actively shapes national narratives through media and public commentary.

➤ Policy Impact

Known for influencing lawmakers and education policies.

➤ Strategic Alignment

Her support would reinforce the campaign's credibility and highlight the urgency of addressing rural inclusion gaps.



Effective press releases balance facts with personality by incorporating credible quotes from organizational leaders, which humanize the message and provide reporters with ready material for their stories (Eggensperger 2022, p. 59).

Mobilise High-Level Advocacy to Amplify Regional Inclusion Issues**Tactic 1: Personalised Advocacy Briefing**

- Create and send Anna Brown a customised policy briefing that includes:
- Summaries of interviewed students' stories
- Research data from Minus18's regional projects
- Key media coverage highlights

Tactic 2: Strategic Co-Signature Opportunity

Invite Anna Brown to co-sign a public letter addressed to the Department of Education or mainstream media, calling for increased resources and attention to regional inclusive education programs.

This letter would be jointly endorsed by Minus18 leadership and other community representatives.

**Transportation Theory**

When individuals become deeply immersed in a story or mentally transported into a narrative world, their real-world beliefs may be influenced by the story (Green 2000, p.701)





Persuasive Objective

Within 3 months (January 2026 to March 2026), engage urban LGBTQIA+ influencers and public figures to amplify messaging and drive donations. Also, remind the public and media outlets that “We’ve already lost two years” and spotlight the lack of rural queer representation.



Strategy 1

Leverage the Influence of Urban LGBTQIA+ Allies for Content Amplification

Tactic 1

Collaborate with The Conversation or ABC to publish an op-ed.

Focus on the topic: “How urban resources can transform rural queer futures.”

Strategy



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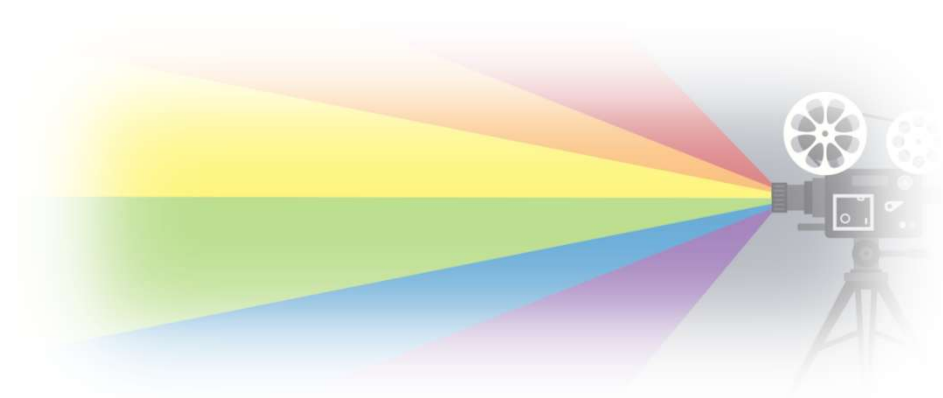


Media Release

Draft and distribute a press release to The Guardian social affairs desk and highlighting the op-ed’s publication and its broader call to action for urban-rural solidarity within the LGBTQIA+ movement.

Contact

David Crowe, Chief Political Correspondent –
dcrowe@smh.com.au



Tactics for Strategy 1

Tactic 2

Create an online donation page + QR code integration

Embed in news articles, social media posts, and digital ads for seamless public access and engagement.



Reference

Morgan, R. M., & Hunt, S. D. (1994). The commitment-trust theory of relationship marketing. *Journal of Marketing*, 58(3), 20–38.



Plant Tour

Guided by Morgan and Hunt's (1994) commitment-trust theory, we will host a virtual impact tour with donors and media, showcasing how past support has improved rural education and mental health. This transparent engagement fosters trust and strengthens long-term commitment.

Contact

Alex Greenwich MP

Role: Independent Member for Sydney in the NSW Parliament.
Why him: A strong advocate for LGBTQIA+ rights, education equity, and mental health. As an openly LGBTQIA+ politician, his involvement adds credibility and draws broader public and political attention.

Local relevance: Represents central Sydney with deep engagement in both urban and regional issues.





Strategy 2

**Amplify the Narrative of
'Forgotten Regions' to Evoke
Media Accountability**

Tactic 1

*Launch the "Queer Out Here, Still Unheard" urban street campaign
A non-physical, visual-led awareness campaign designed for social media traction and to attract coverage by ABC's visual content segments.*



Strategy



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Media Release

By arranging a journalist roundtable and inviting reporters from ABC Queer, SBS Voices, and freelance writers like Yves Rees (whose work often intersects with queer identity and marginality).

Contact

- 1.ABC Queer Editor: Matthew Wade – wadem@abc.net.au
- 2.Alex Greenwich

Independent MP for Sydney, openly gay, long-time advocate for LGBTQIA+ rights.

He can join as a guest to provide policy perspective and strengthen links with lawmakers



Tactic 2

Host a journalist roundtable to encourage media attention

Co-hosted with Minus18, education experts, and media professionals — to be held online or in person — to foster long-term media interest in rural queer issues.



Site Exposure:

As an optional extension informed by witnessing theory and narrative ethics, we will arrange a site visit or virtual tour of a regional queer youth space supported by Minus18. This immersive experience enables journalists to directly engage with the emotional isolation and resource gaps rural queer youth face, fostering more empathetic and responsible storytelling.

As an optional extension grounded in witnessing theory (Felman & Laub, 1992) and narrative ethics (Frank, 2010), we will arrange a site visit or virtual tour of a regional queer youth space supported by Minus18. This first-hand engagement fosters deeper empathy and more ethical, accurate storytelling.

Felman, S., & Laub, D. (1992). *Testimony: Crises of Witnessing in Literature, Psychoanalysis, and History*. Routledge.

Frank, A. W. (2010). *Letting Stories Breathe: A Socio-narratology*. University of Chicago Press.





Timeline, Budget & Evaluation

✦ 6-Month Media Relations Plan ✦ 2025-2026

Strategy	Tactic	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
Tailor Stories to Journalists for Maximum Reach	Visual Media Kit & Inclusive Pitch						
	Exclusive Briefing & Story Pitch						
Mobilise Advocacy for Regional Inclusion	Personalised Advocacy Briefing						
	Strategic Co-Signature Opportunity						
Engage Urban LGBTQIA+ Allies for Wider Impact	Op-ed with ABC/The conversation on urban support						
	Donation page with QR code integration						
Highlight Forgotten Regions for Media Impact	Queer out here' visual awareness campaign						
	Journalist roundtable on rural Queer issues						

This six-month plan schedules key tactics across four focus areas — ensuring ongoing media attention, stronger audience engagement, and lasting connections with ABC and The Guardian.



Media Relations Budget Overview

Item	Estimated Cost	Notes
Media Kit Design	\$500	Includes design, layout, and licensed images
Media Luncheon (2 events)	\$800	Light meal for 8 guests per session
Media Monitoring Service	\$600	Using platforms like Meltwater or Isentia
Vedio Content Production	\$900	Interview filming and editing
Total	\$2800	Adjustable based on campaign needs



This budget focuses on essential media engagement costs — from content production to relationship-building activities. Each item is strategically allocated to maximise media exposure, stakeholder engagement, and campaign outcomes.

Evaluation

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**Media
Exposure**

Objective

**Fundraising
Performance**

**Topic
Impact**

**Media
Relationship
Building**

**Expected
Outcomes**

Measurement

Number of media reports, audience reach

Click-through rates, donation amount

Secondary coverage, audience interaction

Media response rate, future collaboration

Coverage by ABC & The Guardian with national reach

Achieve 50% rural school outreach target

Reposts, comments, and positive engagement

Establish stable contacts with key journalists



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